

CAROLINA LOPEZ

The World Bank
1818 H Street, NW
Washington, DC 20433

www.jcarolinalopez.com
carolina_lopez@worldbank.org

Education:

Ph.D. in Economics, Brown University	2015-2022
Ph.D. Student in Economics, Universidad Nacional de La Plata	2012-2015
M.A. in Economics, Universidad Nacional de La Plata, <i>summa cum laude</i>	2012
B.A. in Economics, Universidad Nacional de Salta	2010

Positions:

Research Economist, The World Bank's Development Research Group	2023-
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Harvard Kennedy School	2022-2023

Research Fields:

Primary fields: Development Economics, Economics of Education, Behavioral Economics

Publications:

- “Exacerbated Inequalities: the Learning Loss from COVID-19 in Italy” (with Michela Carlana and Eliana La Ferrara), *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, vol. 113, pp. 489-493 (2023).
- “Does Patient Demand Contribute to the Overuse of Prescription Drugs?” (with Anja Sautmann and Simone Schaner), *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, vol. 14, number 1, 225–260 (2022).
- “Long-run effects of youth training programs: Experimental evidence from Argentina” (with María Laura Alzúa and Guillermo Cruces) *Economic Inquiry*, vol. 54, issue 4, pp. 1839–1859 (2016).
- “Effect of a community-led sanitation intervention on child diarrhoea and child growth in rural Mali: A cluster randomized controlled trial” (with Amy Pickering, Habiba Djebbari, Massa Coulibaly, and Maria Laura Alzua). *The Lancet Global Health*, vol. 3, number 11, pp. 701–711 (2015).
- “The long and winding road towards fiscal decentralization” (with María Laura Alzúa). *Económica – Universidad Nacional de La Plata*, vol. LX, pp. 3-43 (2014).
- “Un Analisis Multidimensional de la Pobreza: Evidencia Reciente de las Regiones de Argentina” (with Romina Safojan). *Revista de Economía Política de Buenos Aires - Universidad de Buenos Aires (REPBA)*, 7, vol. 12, pp. 9-44 (2013).

Working Papers & Work in Progress:

- “Tripping at the Finish Line: Experimental Evidence on the Role of Misperceptions on Secondary School Completion”
- “The Economics Performance of Native Groups in Argentina” (with Pedro Dal Bó), *NBER Working Paper 32704 | World Bank Policy Research Working Paper 10834*.
- “Do Patients Value High-Quality Medical Care? Experimental Evidence from Malaria Diagnosis and Treatment” (with Anja Sautmann and Simone Schaner), *NBER Working Paper 32075 | World Bank Policy Research Working Paper 10746. R&R Journal of Human Resources*.
- “Improving Student Learning through Adaptive Learning Platforms: Experimental Evidence from the Dominican Republic” (with Astrid Pineda), *World Bank Policy Research Working Paper 11418. Submitted*.
- “Not Faster, but Better: Generative AI and Teacher Skill in Peru” (with Carla Z. Glave, Ezequiel Molina and Román Andrés Zárate), *World Bank Policy Research Working Paper Series, forthcoming*.
- “Scaling up classroom observation with large language models: A reliability study of the World Bank's Teach framework in Peru” (with Jostin Kitmang, Matthew D. Krasnow, William J. Krasnow, Ezequiel Molina, and Carolina Moreira Vasquez). *Submitted*.
- “The Personalization Trap: Does AI Tutoring Build Learners or Dependence?” (with Ezequiel Molina and Germán Reyes)

Books:

- *El Director LIBRE: El Método de IA que Libera Horas de Papeleo para Liderar el Aprendizaje* (with Ezequiel Molina, Octavio Lizama, and Paul Bambrick-Santoyo). World Bank (2025).

Professional Activities:*Presentations*

Spring, 2026	LEER conference KU-Leuven
Fall, 2025	AI & Future of Human Capital Knowledge Symposium (George Washington University and The World Bank), Economics of Education Seminar (The World Bank), Global School Leaders Summit, Universidad Nacional de La Plata
Winter, 2025	Inter-American Development Bank, Middlebury College, RIDGE Public Economics, SOLE
Fall, 2024	University of Maryland (AREC Seminar), World Bank Half-Baked Seminar, Asociación Argentina de Economía Política (AAEP), Universidad Nacional de Salta (UNSa Argentina)
Spring, 2024	LEER Conference (KU Leuven), RIDGE Public Economics (PUC Chile), Seminario de Investigación Instituto de Investigaciones Económicas (UNLP Argentina)
Fall, 2023	Congreso Internacional Ideice (Dominican Republic), Southern Economic Association, Workshop on Educational choices and transitions in secondary and higher education (PSE), Workshop on Economics of Education (UAndes Chile)
Spring, 2023	Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PacDev), Society of Labor Economics (SOLE)
Fall, 2022	Economics and Social Policy Seminar Series (Harvard University)
Spring, 2022	Economic Science Association, Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP)
Fall, 2021	Applied Microeconomics Lunch Seminar, Brown University; Department of Economics at Universidad Nacional de La Plata; Rising Scholars Conference Harvard Business School; LACEA RIDGE Job Market Showcase; Asociación Argentina de Economía Política at Universidad de Buenos Aires; NEUDC; Economic Science Association Job Market Seminar
Spring, 2021	Population Association of America, Washington
Fall, 2020	Applied Microeconomics Lunch Seminar, Brown University
Spring, 2020	Universidad Católica de Salta, Argentina; Applied Microeconomics Lunch Seminar, Brown University
Spring, 2019	Population Association of America, Austin
Fall, 2018	Applied Microeconomics Lunch Seminar, Brown University
Spring, 2017	Applied Microeconomics Lunch Seminar, Brown University
Spring, 2015	Canadian Economic Association, Ryerson University

Referee

Journal of Development Economics, Oxford Development Studies, American Economic Review, Review of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, *Económica*, World Bank Economic Review, Education Economics, American Journal of Health Economics.

Research Grants:

Spring 2026	Strategic Impact Evaluation Fund (SIEF), World Bank, \$400,000, “The Personalization Trap: AI Tutor Design for Durable Learning in Lima’s Public Schools” (with Ezequiel Molina and Germán Reyes)
Fall 2025	Microsoft AI in Education Initiative (AIEI) — \$80,000
Spring 2025	Strategic Impact Evaluation Fund (SIEF), World Bank, \$350,000 (with Damien de Walque)
Fall 2024	Human Capital Project “AI for People” award, World Bank, \$100,000 (with Ezequiel Molina)
Fall 2022	Tinker Foundation
Summer-2021	Summer Funding, Graduate Program in Development. Watson Institute for International and Public Affairs, Brown University

Spring-2021	Bravo Center Award, Department of Economics, Brown University
Fall-2020	Bravo Center Award, Department of Economics, Brown University
Summer-2019	Award for Research Proposals on “Human capital formation and youth access to high-quality employment in Latin America” CAF
Summer-2019	Summer Award to Promote Population Research Projects, Population Studies and Training Center, Brown University
Summer-2019	Summer Funding, Graduate Program in Development. Watson Institute for International and Public Affairs, Brown University
Spring-2018	Sarmiento Research Award for Latin American Studies. Center for Latin American and Caribbean Studies (CLACS), Brown University

Other Information:

Languages: English (fluent), Spanish (native), French (beginner)

Citizenship: Argentina